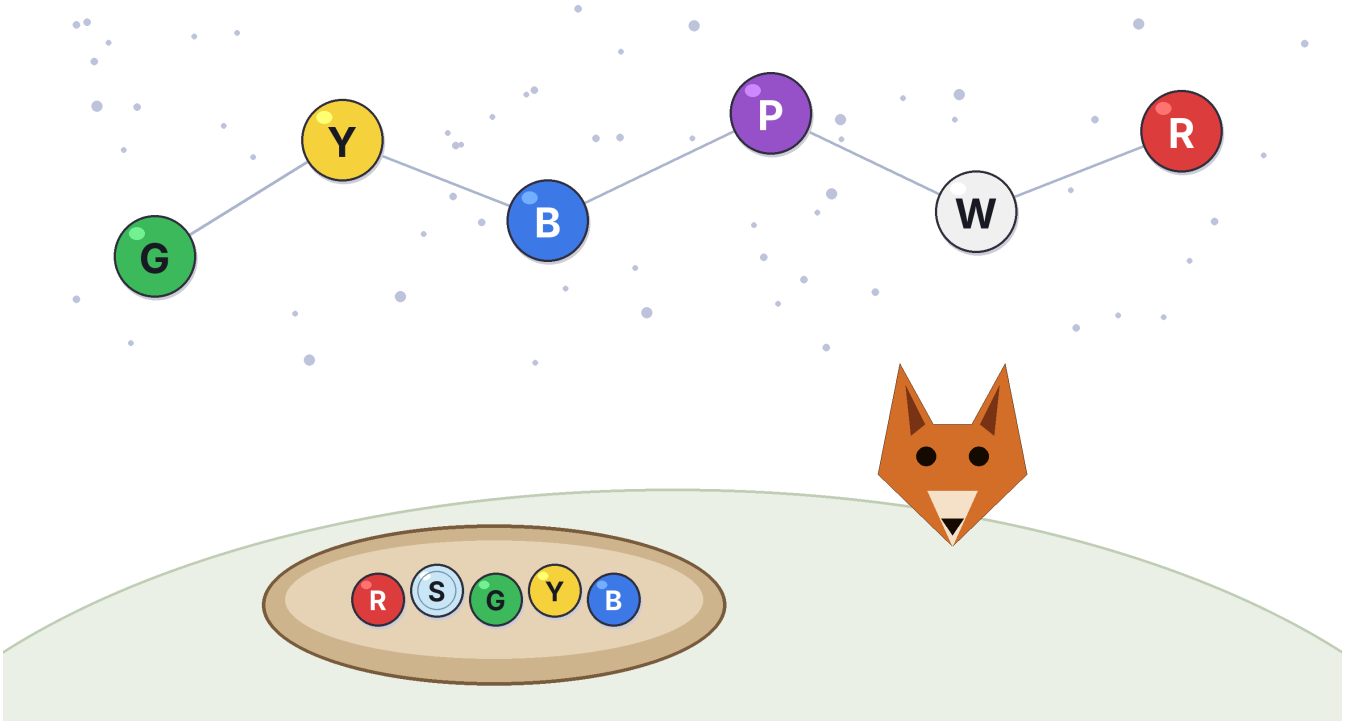
ILLUSTRATED RULES & TABLE REFERENCE

# Spirits of the Wild

## 2 players · about 30 minutes

Gather precious stones, offer them to five animal spirits and keep the jealous Coyote off your board. This booklet explains every rule in plain words, with pictures, and ends with a score sheet and a one-page quick reference.




| Rabbit | Turtle | Salmon | Owl | Beaver |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| G Y R | B B B | G B P | R R | W W W |
| 3 different colours | all one colour | all different | same-colour pairs | 3 of a kind + a pair |

**Inside**


2 Goal & components
3 Setup
4 Your turn
5 The action cards
6 Animals: Rabbit, Turtle, Salmon
7 Animals: Owl, Beaver, example
8 Spirit Stones & the Coyote
9 Spirit Power cards
10 End of game & FAQ
11 Score sheet
12 Quick reference



Unofficial player aid for personal use, written in our own words with original illustrations. *Spirits of the Wild* is a game by Nick Hayes, published by Mattel; the name is a trademark of Mattel.

EDITION This manual scores Owl pairs at **4 points** (German 2019 rules); the English 2017 printing says 3 — agree before you play.

OVERVIEW

# The goal of the game

Long ago five forest animals became stars, and they have returned as spirits. Each spirit loves certain gifts. Bring them the right stones and earn their favour — but the jealous Coyote blocks any animal he sits on.

**Win by having the most points.** On each turn you play one action card to collect stones and place them on the five animals of your board — each animal accepts only certain stones and scores for the sets you build. The game ends as soon as **five clear Spirit Stones** have come out of the bag.

## A game in four sentences

1. Play one **face-up action card**, do what it says, then flip it face-down.
2. Put every stone you take on an animal that **accepts** it; if none does, the stone goes back to the bowl.
3. When three of your other cards are face-down you may use a **Spirit Power** and turn all your cards face-up again.
4. A clear **Spirit Stone** doubles an animal's points but closes it — and the fifth one out of the bag ends the game.

## Components

| Item | Qty |
|---|---|
| Bowl | 1 |
| Cloth bag | 1 |
| Coyote pawn | 1 |
| Player boards (5 animals each) | 2 |
| Action cards (6 per player) | 12 |
| Spirit Power cards: Bear, Wolf, Ram, Eagle, Deer, Bison | 6 |
| Stones (8 of each of 7 kinds) | 56 |




Six **regular colours** plus the clear **Spirit Stones**. A Spirit Stone is **not** a seventh colour. In this booklet every stone carries its initial (G Y B P W R, S = Spirit Stone), so the pictures also work in black and white.

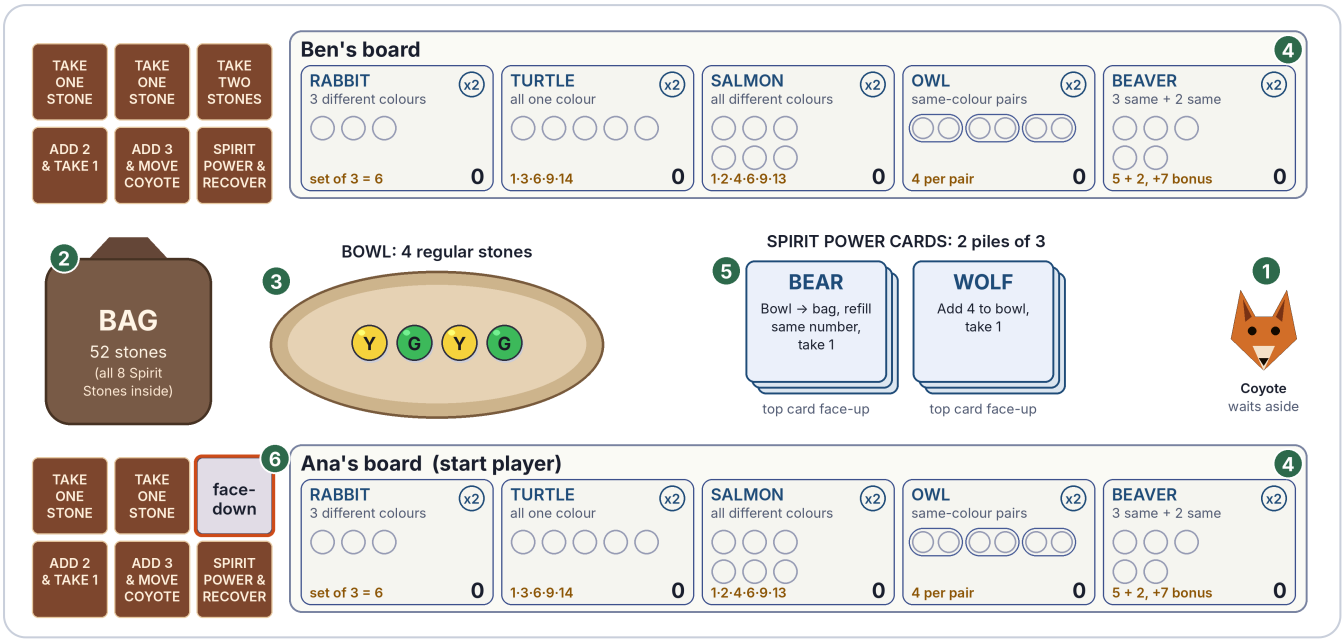
## Words used in this booklet

| | |
|---|---|
| **Bowl** | The open pool of stones in the middle. "Take" always means take from the bowl, choosing freely. |
| **Bag** | The hidden supply. "Draw" or "add" means pull stones blindly from the bag. |
| **Section** | One animal on your board: its stone spaces plus a **×2 bonus space** for a Spirit Stone. |
| **Open / closed** | A section is closed once it holds a Spirit Stone; it is blocked while the Coyote sits on it. Neither accepts new stones. |
| **Face-up / face-down** | Face-up action cards are available; face-down cards are used until you recover them. |

BEFORE YOU PLAY

# Setup

Takes about two minutes. The numbers match the picture.




Example table after setup (Ana starts). Ben sits opposite; his board is shown the right way up for reading.

1. **Middle of the table.** Place the bowl between the players. Put the Coyote pawn to one side — at the start it blocks nobody.
2. **Fill the bag.** All 56 stones go in the cloth bag. Shake it.
3. **Seed the bowl.** Draw stones into the bowl until it holds **4 regular stones**. Any clear Spirit Stone drawn now goes straight back into the bag and you draw again.
4. **Player areas.** Each player takes a board and lays their 6 action cards **face-up** in front of it.
5. **Spirit Powers.** Shuffle the 6 Spirit Power cards into **two face-up piles of 3**. Only the top card of each pile can be used.
6. **Start player.** Choose any way you like. The start player turns their **Take Two Stones** card face-down — it stays unavailable until they recover their cards. This balances the advantage of going first.

FIRST GAME? Read pages 4–6 together, then start playing and look things up as they come. Keep the quick reference (back page) face-up next to the bowl, and say the Spirit Stone count out loud whenever a clear stone leaves the bag.

**Check before the first turn:** 4 regular stones in the bowl · 0 Spirit Stones out of the bag · 2 Spirit piles, top cards visible · start player's Take Two Stones face-down · Coyote off both boards.

HOW TO PLAY

# Your turn

Players alternate. A turn is always the same three steps.

**1 Choose**
Pick **one face-up** action card. You may only choose a card you can carry out: any stones it tells you to **take** must already be in the bowl.

→

**2 Do it**
Carry out the whole card. Place each stone you take on your board **at once** (see below).

→

**3 Flip it**
Turn the card **face-down**. It can't be used again until you recover your cards.

**End of every turn:** count the clear Spirit Stones that are out of the bag (bowl + both boards). **Five or more? The game ends now** — go to final scoring (page 10). Otherwise it's your opponent's turn.

## Getting your cards back

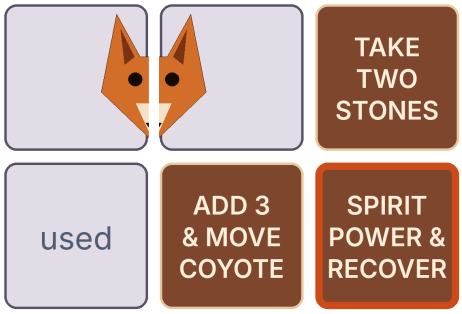
Each card works once per cycle, so you will run out. Your sixth card, **Use Spirit Power & Recover Cards**, can be chosen only when **at least three of your other five cards are face-down**. It lets you:

a. use one of the two face-up **Spirit Power** cards (page 9),

b. slide that Spirit card to the **bottom of its pile**,

c. turn **all six** of your action cards face-up again — this one included.

Recovering is optional: you may keep playing other face-up cards instead.




Three cards are face-down, so **Spirit Power & Recover** (outlined) may be played. Both *Take One Stone* backs are down, which also shows the complete Coyote (page 8).

## Placing stones

- A stone may go only on an animal whose **requirement** it meets (pages 6–7).
- If a stone you take fits **nowhere** on your board, put it **back in the bowl**. That is still a legal play.
- Placed stones stay put. (Only the Deer power moves one back to the bowl.)
- A clear Spirit Stone goes only in an animal's **×2 bonus space** (page 8).
- No stone of any kind may be added to a **closed** animal (holds a Spirit Stone) or a **blocked** one (the Coyote sits on it).
- Cards that only **add** stones to the bowl, and the optional Coyote move, never stop you from playing a card.

**Example turn**

Ana's Turtle holds two (B) blue stones. She plays **Add Two Stones & Take One**: she draws a (R) red and a (S) Spirit Stone from the bag into the bowl (now 1 Spirit Stone is out). She takes a (B) blue stone that was already in the bowl and adds it to her Turtle (3 blue = 6 points), then flips the card face-down. At the end of her turn only one Spirit Stone is out, so Ben plays next.

REFERENCE

# The action cards

Each player has the same six cards (two of them identical). Play one per turn, then flip it face-down.

TAKE ONE STONE

### Take One Stone ×2 PER PLAYER

Take **1 stone** of your choice from the bowl and place it on your board.

**Playable when:** the bowl holds at least 1 stone.

**Card back:** half a Coyote (see the Coyote box on this page).

TAKE TWO STONES

### Take Two Stones

Take **2 stones** of your choice from the bowl and place them on your board.

**Playable when:** the bowl holds at least 2 stones.

The start player begins the game with this card face-down.

ADD 2 & TAKE 1

### Add Two Stones & Take One

**Draw 2 stones** from the bag (without looking) into the bowl. Then **take 1 stone** of your choice from the bowl and place it.

You may take one of the new stones or one that was already there.

ADD 3 & MOVE COYOTE

### Add Three Stones & Move Coyote

**Draw 3 stones** from the bag into the bowl. Then you **may** put the Coyote on any one animal of your **opponent's** board.

You take **no** stone with this card. Think about what you leave in the bowl for your opponent.

SPIRIT POWER & RECOVER

### Use Spirit Power & Recover Cards

1. Choose the top card of either Spirit Power pile.
2. Do its effect, step by step in the order written (page 9).
3. Put that card at the bottom of its own pile.
4. Turn all six of your action cards face-up.

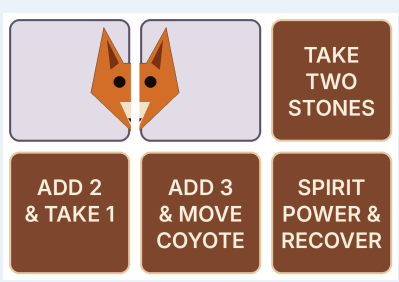
**Playable when:** at least **3 of your other 5** cards are face-down.



### The two Coyote halves

The back of each **Take One Stone** card shows half of the Coyote. When the second of them is turned face-down the picture is complete: after taking your stone you **may move the Coyote** to any animal on your opponent's board.

This can happen once per cycle of your cards, because recovering flips both back face-up.

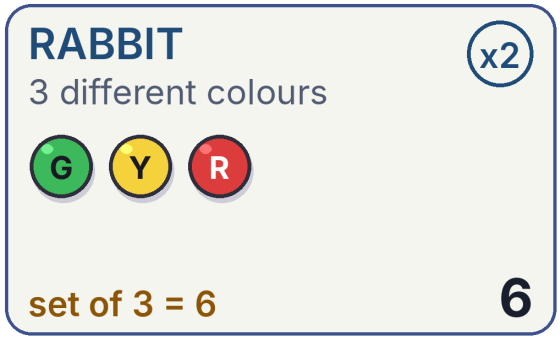



**Both Take One Stone cards face-down = a whole Coyote.** Together with *Add Three Stones & Move Coyote*, that gives you two ways per cycle to send the Coyote to your opponent. Full Coyote rules: page 8.

YOUR BOARD · 1 OF 2

# The five animals

Every animal accepts only certain stones and scores for what it holds at the end. Any animal may also take one Spirit Stone in its ×2 space (page 8).




G Y R green, yellow, red: complete = **6**.

## Rabbit

**Three stones, all of different colours**

- Scores **6 points**, but only when all 3 stones are in place.
- An unfinished Rabbit scores **nothing**.

| Stones | 3 |
|---|---|
| **Points** | **6** |

TIP An easy 6 points — but it counts only once all three stones are there. Don't leave it unfinished when the Spirit Stones run low.




Four B blue = **9**. A fifth blue would make it 14.

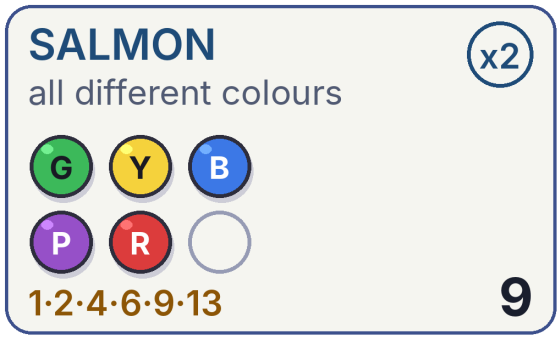
## Turtle

**Every stone the same colour**

- Up to 5 stones, all of **one** colour.
- The 5th stone is the big jump: 9 → 14.

| Stones | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Points** | **1** | **3** | **6** | **9** | **14** |

TIP Choose a colour that is easy to get. A full Turtle with a Spirit Stone is worth 28.




Five different (G Y B P R) = **9**. Adding W white would make 13.

## Salmon

**Every stone a different colour**

- Up to 6 stones, **one of each** regular colour.
- Points grow fastest at the end: 9 → 13.

| Stones | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Points** | **1** | **2** | **4** | **6** | **9** | **13** |

TIP Almost any stone fits early on, which makes the Salmon a good home for leftovers. Full with a Spirit Stone: 26.

# The five animals (continued)

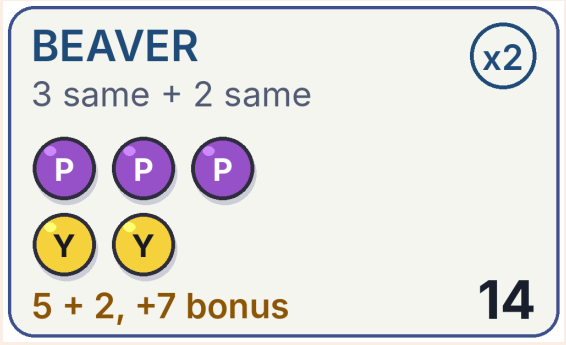



R R + W W + G = 2 pairs = **8**. Use the number of Owl spaces printed on your board.

## Owl

### Pairs of the same colour

- Each **completed pair** scores **4 points**. A lone half-pair scores nothing.
- Pairs may be different colours from each other, and you may start a new pair before finishing another.
- EDITION English 2017 rules: 3 points per pair.




Three P purple + two Y yellow = 5 + 2 + 7 = **14**.

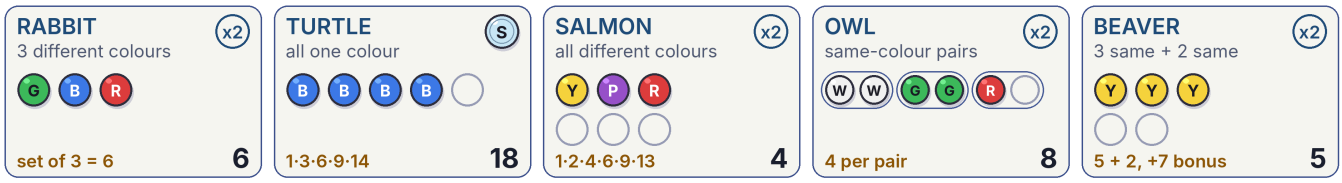
## Beaver

### Three of a kind + a pair

- **Three-of-a-kind** (3 of one colour) = **5**.
- **Pair** (2 of one colour) = **2**.
- Both complete: **+7 bonus**, so **14** in total. Work on either set first; only completed sets score.

| Sets | 3 same | 2 same | both |
|---|---|---|---|
| Points | **5** | **2** | **14** |

## Worked scoring example




Mia's board at the end of the game. The number at the bottom right of each animal is its final score.

| Animal | What's there | Pts | Spirit | Score |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Rabbit** | green, blue, red: complete | 6 | | **6** |
| **Turtle** | 4 blue + Spirit Stone | 9 | ×2 | **18** |
| **Salmon** | yellow, purple, red | 4 | | **4** |
| **Owl** | 2 pairs (white, green) + 1 single red | 8 | | **8** |
| **Beaver** | three yellow; pair not started | 5 | | **5** |
| | | | **Total** | **41** |

**Notice:** the single red stone on the Owl and the missing Beaver pair score nothing. The Spirit Stone on the 4-stone Turtle doubled 9 to 18 — on a full Turtle it would have been 28.

SPECIAL PIECES

# Spirit Stones

The 8 clear (opalescent) stones (S) are not a colour. They follow their own rules:

- Only in an animal's **×2 bonus space**, never in a normal space.
- At the end, that animal's points are **doubled**.
- It **closes** the animal: no more stones of any kind may be added there.
- Never counts toward a colour requirement (Rabbit, Salmon…).
- Taken but no open bonus space (all closed or blocked)? It goes **back to the bowl**.

TIP Place it when the animal is full or nearly full — unless the game is about to end. Double zero is still zero.




Five (R) red on the Turtle (14) with a Spirit Stone = **28**. The Turtle is now closed.




**The game clock.** Spirit Stones out of the bag — in the bowl *and* on both boards — count towards the end. Check at the **end of every turn**: with **five or more out**, the game ends immediately. If the Bison power puts one back in the bag before the turn ends, the count drops and play goes on.

# The Coyote

The jealous trickster. While the Coyote sits on one of your animals you **can't add any stone** there — not even a Spirit Stone. Stones already there stay and still score. The block ends when the Coyote moves on.

### Two ways to move him onto your opponent's board

1. **Add Three Stones & Move Coyote**: after adding the 3 stones you *may* put him on any of your opponent's animals.
2. **Both Take One Stone cards face-down**: their backs form a whole Coyote, and you may move him the same way.




Coyote on the Salmon: its 3 stones still score 4, but nothing more can be added.

- There is one Coyote: it is on at most one animal. Moving it frees the animal it left.
- Always onto your **opponent's** board, never your own.
- A closed animal (with a Spirit Stone) may be chosen, but blocking it achieves nothing.
- **Ties:** the player with the Coyote on their board wins (page 10).

REFERENCE

# Spirit Power cards

Played through **Use Spirit Power & Recover Cards**. Pick the top card of either pile and resolve it **in the order written**. Every stone you take is placed on your board as usual (or returned to the bowl if it fits nowhere).

## BEAR

Shake up the bowl

1. Count the stones in the bowl.
2. Put them all back in the bag.
3. Draw the **same number** from the bag into the bowl.
4. Take **1 stone** from the bowl.

## WOLF

Big refill

1. Draw **4 stones** from the bag into the bowl.
2. Take **1 stone** from the bowl.

## RAM

Straight from the bag

1. Draw **2 stones** from the bag.
2. Place both **directly on your board** — you must if you legally can (a Spirit Stone too).
3. Any you can't place go into the bowl.

## EAGLE

Extra turn

1. Take **1 stone** from the bowl.
2. Recover your action cards as usual.
3. Take **another turn** at once, with all six cards face-up.

## DEER

Swap

1. Move **1 stone** from your board back to the bowl.
2. Take **2 stones** from the bowl.

## BISON

Take one, send one back

1. Draw **3 stones** from the bag into the bowl.
2. Take **1 stone** from the bowl.
3. Return **another stone** from the bowl to the bag (any stone, new or old — even a Spirit Stone).

**After every Spirit Power:** slide the used card to the **bottom of its own pile** (a new top card appears), then turn **all six** of your action cards face-up.

## Good to know

- **Eagle** is the only way to play two turns in a row — and you start the extra turn with all cards ready.
- **Deer** can break a set (e.g. an Owl pair) if you remove a stone from it.
- **Bison** can pull a Spirit Stone back into the bag: handy to delay the end when you're behind, or to deny one to your opponent.
- Look at both top cards early and time your recovery for the one you want.

FINISHING

# End of the game & scoring

**When does it end?**

At the **end of any turn** in which **5 Spirit Stones are out of the bag** (bowl + both boards together), the game ends immediately. No further turns.

**Who wins?**

The higher total wins. **Tie:** the player who has the **Coyote on their board** wins — the spirits take pity on the one he bothered.

## Final scoring, step by step

1. Score each of your five animals (table right). Unfinished sets score nothing.
2. **Double** each animal with a Spirit Stone in its bonus space.
3. Add the five results. The score sheet on page 11 helps.

| Animal | Points |
|---|---|
| Rabbit | 6 if complete (3 different) |
| Turtle | 1 · 3 · 6 · 9 · 14 for 1–5 same colour |
| Salmon | 1 · 2 · 4 · 6 · 9 · 13 for 1–6 different |
| Owl | 4 per complete pair (3 in English 2017 ed.) |
| Beaver | 3 same = 5 · pair = 2 · both = 14 |

## FAQ & clarifications

Answers follow the printed rules. Where the rules are silent, a suggestion is marked HOUSE RULE — agree on it before you start.

**Can I play a card if part of it can't be done?**
Stones you must **take** have to be in the bowl. Adding stones from the bag and the optional Coyote move never block a card. Taking a stone you can't place is legal: it goes back to the bowl.

**How many spaces does each animal have?**
The scoring implies Rabbit 3, Turtle 5, Salmon 6, Beaver 3 + 2. For the Owl use the spaces printed on your board. Always follow your physical board.

**Can a Spirit Stone go on an empty animal?**
Nothing forbids it, but it closes the animal and double zero is zero — almost never worth it.

**Does the game end the moment the 5th Spirit Stone appears?**
No: you finish the turn first, then check. That matters for the Bison, which can return one.

**Eagle: do I recover before the extra turn?**
Yes. Take your stone, turn all six cards face-up, then play your extra turn.

**Ram: must I place a drawn Spirit Stone?**
Yes, if you have an open bonus space. Anything you can't place goes to the bowl.

**When exactly do the Coyote halves trigger?**
When the second Take One Stone card is flipped face-down, after taking its stone. Once per cycle.

**Deer: can I remove a Spirit Stone, or a stone from a blocked animal?**
The rules don't restrict which stone. HOUSE RULE Any of your stones may be removed, but you still can't add stones to a closed or blocked animal. Agree before play.

**What if the bag runs out?**
HOUSE RULE Draw what is left; with an empty bag a draw step does nothing. Carry out the rest of the card as far as possible.

**Tie, and the Coyote was never used?**
HOUSE RULE Share the victory.

**Strategy tips** NOT RULES

- Count the Spirit Stones out of the bag. At three or four, every draw could end the game — make sure your board scores *now*.
- Rabbit, Owl pairs and Beaver sets score nothing unfinished. Avoid many half-sets late in the game.
- Send the Coyote to your opponent's best *open* animal, usually a Turtle or Salmon just before its big jump.
- Stones you add to the bowl help your opponent too — check what colours they need first.

PHOTOCOPY ME

# Score sheet

Write each animal's points **before** doubling and tick ×2 if it holds a Spirit Stone; doubled animals count twice in the total. Rabbit 6 · Turtle 1/3/6/9/14 · Salmon 1/2/4/6/9/13 · Owl 4 per pair · Beaver 5 + 2 (+7 if both).

| Game 1 | Player 1: _____ | | Player 2: _____ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | points | ×2 | points | ×2 |
| Rabbit | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Turtle | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Salmon | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Owl | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Beaver | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Total | | | | |
| Coyote on board? | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | |

| Game 2 | Player 1: _____ | | Player 2: _____ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | points | ×2 | points | ×2 |
| Rabbit | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Turtle | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Salmon | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Owl | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Beaver | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Total | | | | |
| Coyote on board? | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | |

| Game 3 | Player 1: _____ | | Player 2: _____ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | points | ×2 | points | ×2 |
| Rabbit | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Turtle | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Salmon | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Owl | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Beaver | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Total | | | | |
| Coyote on board? | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | |

| Game 4 | Player 1: _____ | | Player 2: _____ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | points | ×2 | points | ×2 |
| Rabbit | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Turtle | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Salmon | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Owl | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Beaver | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Total | | | | |
| Coyote on board? | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | |

| Game 5 | Player 1: _____ | | Player 2: _____ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | points | ×2 | points | ×2 |
| Rabbit | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Turtle | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Salmon | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Owl | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Beaver | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Total | | | | |
| Coyote on board? | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | |

| Game 6 | Player 1: _____ | | Player 2: _____ | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | points | ×2 | points | ×2 |
| Rabbit | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Turtle | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Salmon | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Owl | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Beaver | | ☐ | | ☐ |
| Total | | | | |
| Coyote on board? | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | | ☐ yes (wins a tie) | |

KEEP THIS SIDE UP

# Quick reference

### Your turn

1. Choose one **face-up** card (stones it takes must be in the bowl).
2. Do it. Place stones at once; unplaceable → bowl.
3. Flip it **face-down**.

! End of turn: **5 Spirit Stones out** of the bag? Game over.

### Setup

Bowl: 4 regular stones (redraw clear ones) · 6 cards face-up each · Spirit cards in 2 face-up piles of 3 · start player flips **Take Two Stones** face-down · Coyote aside.

## Action cards

| Card | Effect |
|---|---|
| **Take One Stone** (×2) | Take 1 from the bowl. Both face-down = whole Coyote: move it to an opponent's animal. |
| **Take Two Stones** | Take 2 from the bowl (needs 2 there). |
| **Add Two & Take One** | Bag → bowl 2, then take 1. |
| **Add Three & Move Coyote** | Bag → bowl 3, then *may* put the Coyote on an opponent's animal. No stone taken. |
| **Spirit Power & Recover** | Needs ≥ 3 other cards face-down. Use a top Spirit card, put it under its pile, flip **all 6** cards face-up. |

## Spirit Powers

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Bear** | Bowl → bag, redraw the same number, take 1. | **Eagle** | Take 1; after recovering, take another turn. |
| **Wolf** | Bag → bowl 4, take 1. | **Deer** | 1 of your stones → bowl, then take 2. |
| **Ram** | 2 from bag straight to your board (must if possible; rest → bowl). | **Bison** | Bag → bowl 3, take 1, return 1 bowl stone to the bag. |

## Animals

| Animal | Accepts | Points |
|---|---|---|
| **Rabbit** | 3 different colours | 6 (complete only) |
| **Turtle** | all one colour | 1 · 3 · 6 · 9 · 14 (1–5 stones) |
| **Salmon** | all different colours | 1 · 2 · 4 · 6 · 9 · 13 (1–6 stones) |
| **Owl** | same-colour pairs | 4 per complete pair (3 in English 2017 ed.) |
| **Beaver** | 3 of a kind + a pair | 5 + 2, +7 bonus if both = 14 |

### Spirit Stone

Only in a **×2 bonus space** · doubles that animal · **closes** it · not a colour · no open space → bowl.

### Coyote

No stones (not even Spirit Stones) may be added to the animal he sits on. Always moved onto the opponent's board.

**End & winner:** end of a turn with 5 Spirit Stones out of the bag (Bison returning one in time keeps play going) → score, double animals with a Spirit Stone, highest total wins. **Tie:** the player with the Coyote on their board wins.